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Political Divisions of Central India

Topics covered

- Summary of information
- Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Telangana,

Look at the map of these states and fill in the blanks.

1. Madhya Pradesh lies to the north of ..... .
2. Chhattisgarh lies to the west of ..... .
3. Telangana has Odisha and ..... to its north-east.
4. The state of Jharkhand is to the north of ..... .

These states are in the plateau region of India. Much of the land is rocky with some forests. It is mostly very hot and dry here. The table gives a summary of information about these states.

State	Capital and some cities	Rivers	Natural vegetation	Crops	Occupation
Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal—capital Jabalpur, Gwalior	Narmada, Betwa Chambal, Son	Forests with various different trees, bamboo	Wheat, jowar, sugar cane, soya beans, cotton, pulses, oilseeds	Farming, oil crushing, sugar factories, beedi making
Jharkhand	Ranchi—capital Bokaro, Jamshedpur	Subarnarekha, Kharkai, Damodar	Some forests with deciduous trees	Rice, maize, pulses, oilseeds	Working in factories, farming, cattle rearing and handicraft making

State	Capital and some cities	Rivers	Natural vegetation	Crops	Occupation
Chhattisgarh	Raipur—capital Bhilai, Bilaspur	Mahanadi, Indravati, Shivnath	Deciduous forests and bamboo	Rice, maize, oilseeds, millets, cotton	Farming, silk weaving, handicrafts, beedi making, working in factories
Telangana	Hyderabad—capital Warangal, Nizamabad, Karimnagar	Godavari, Krishna	Thorny vegetation and some forests with deciduous trees	Rice, tobacco, chillies, cotton, oilseeds	Farming, working in the factories and offices, textiles, handicrafts

MADHYA PRADESH

Capital and other cities: This state is in the heart of India. In fact, that is what its name means—Madhya means 'centre' and Pradesh means 'land'. Bhopal is its capital. Indore and Jabalpur are important cities.

The prehistoric rock art at the World Heritage Site of Bhimbetka, east of Bhopal

Rivers: The Narmada is the main river flowing through the state. The Chambal, a tributary of the Yamuna, forms a border for the state with Rajasthan. Another tributary of the Yamuna, the Betwa, and the Son, a tributary of the Ganga, also flow here.

Royal Bengal tigers on the road at Bandhavgarh National Park in Madhya Pradesh

Natural vegetation: The higher parts of the plateau region have forests with sal and teak trees and bamboo. There are also trees whose gum is used for medicine and **incense**. Tendu trees are also found in plenty. The leaves are used to make beedis (local cigarettes).

Crops: The most important crops are wheat, jowar, rice, pulses, oilseeds

(from which cooking oil is obtained) and soya beans of which Madhya Pradesh is the largest producer in India. Sugar cane and cotton are also grown as the soil is suitable for them.

Occupation: Most people live in rural areas and are farmers. The tribal people live in the forests. Apart from farming, there are industries based on agriculture, like oil crushing, and beedi and sugar making. Many people work in these small factories and industries.

JHARKHAND

Jharkhand has several beautiful waterfalls.

Capital and other cities: The capital city is Ranchi from where the state is governed. Jamshedpur, also called Steel City because of the steel plant here, is close to the capital. Bokaro also has a steel plant.

Rivers: The main rivers are Subarnarekha and Kharkai. The **confluence** (meeting) of the rivers near Jamshedpur is a beautiful spot. Another important river is the Damodar.

Natural vegetation: Much of the plateau areas is forested with deciduous trees like sal and asan. The leaves of the asan tree provide food for silkworms. There are also several other trees that provide lac, a type of **resin** used to make **varnish** (a liquid that gives a shiny surface when it is painted onto wood or metal). The land in the plains has been cleared for cultivation.

Coal being carried to a truck that will take it to be sorted for size and quality

Crops: The main crop is rice, but maize, pulses and oilseeds are also important.

Occupation: There are several people who work in the many factories. This is because the state has a lot of iron and coal which are

used in many industries. Others are engaged in farming and cattle rearing. Sheep, goats and pigs are reared in many parts of the state. The tribal people make toys, ornaments and bamboo handicrafts.

CHHATTISGARH

Capital and other cities: The capital city Raipur is in the plains of central Chhattisgarh. Bhilai is another big city where there is a huge steel plant. Bilaspur is also an important town.

Rivers: The main river of the state is the Mahanadi. It has its source near Raipur. It meets the river Shivnath near Bilaspur. The Indravati is another important river.

The Chitrakote Falls on the Indravati River are the widest in India.

Natural vegetation: Most of the plateau region of the state has forests and hills with deciduous trees. The trees are used for resin, incense, medicines and beedis. Bamboo is also found in plenty.

Crops: The plains grow a lot of rice. Maize, millets, oilseeds and cotton are other crops.

Occupation: Most people live in the villages. Forests have tribal people. Farming, silk weaving, beedi making are all common. The tribal people are known for their handicrafts made of metal. In the cities, most people work in the factories that produce steel or cement.

Tribal dance—notice the headgear and jewellery.

Think and answer

Why is farming difficult in the rocky areas?

Discuss

SI

What is the cooking oil used at your home and what is it made of?

TELANGANA

Capital and other cities: This state was previously part of Andhra Pradesh and was created in 2014. The city of Hyderabad is the joint capital of both states, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. Warangal, Nizamabad and Karimnagar are other important cities.

Rivers: The Godavari and the Krishna flow through the state.

Tribal art on the walls of huts—the designs are also used on fabrics, mugs and bowls.

Natural vegetation: The rocky parts of the plateau have only thorny vegetation. Areas near the Godavari have thick forests. Other areas have deciduous trees like neem, rosewood and teak as well as dry grass.

Crops: Rice, tobacco, cotton, oilseeds and chillies are the main crops.

The thousand-pillar temple at Warangal is about 800 years old.

Occupation: Farming is an important occupation in rural areas. In the cities, people work in factories that make medicines and engineering goods. Large numbers of people work in the offices of the IT (Information Technology) industry. Many people also work in the textile and handicraft industries where silver work and wooden toys are made.

Did you Know?

The word 'Deccan' comes from the Sanskrit word 'Dakshin' meaning South. So the Deccan Plateau is also called the Southern Plateau.

The strong walls around the Golconda Fort, which is many centuries old, protected the people inside.

Values and Life Skills

Trees in the forests in these states are cut for many different reasons. This affects many tribal people who live and work in the forests. How can we protect them?

REMEMBER

1. The states have rocky or hilly terrain. All of them have forests.
2. They are hot and dry with limited rainfall in most regions.
3. Rice is grown in all the states.

NEW WORDS

Prehistoric	a time in history before information was written down
Incense	a natural substance that is burned to produce a sweet and pleasant smell
Confluence	the place where two rivers join together and become one
Resin	a sticky substance produced by trees
Varnish	a liquid that gives a shiny, transparent surface when it is painted onto wood or metal

EXERCISES

A. Name them.

1. A national park in Madhya Pradesh .....
2. The tree that feeds silkworms .....
3. Steel City .....
4. A waterfall in Chhattisgarh .....
5. A city that is a joint capital of two states .....

B. Brain teaser

Find the names of seven rivers in this maze.

K	W	R	T	K	L	Q	O	P	D	F	J
H	X	M	A	H	A	N	A	D	I	I	L
A	T	H	J	K	T	W	E	C	Z	B	I
R	Q	S	O	N	F	V	T	H	Y	R	N
K	S	Y	B	M	W	T	U	L	A	F	D
A	H	A	Q	E	J	I	V	D	M	G	R
I	X	V	B	R	T	Y	H	M	U	B	A
T	K	R	I	S	H	N	A	G	N	H	V
H	P	O	L	T	F	E	J	M	A	U	A
I	G	O	D	A	V	A	R	I	Y	M	T
R	S	R	G	Q	B	W	Z	I	O	K	I
S	U	B	A	R	N	A	R	E	K	H	A

C. Find the pairs.

Use a different colour to circle each pair.

Ranchi, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Raipur, Godavari, Chambal

D. Fill in the blanks.

1. The state that is called the heart of India is ..... .
2. ..... in Chhattisgarh has a huge steel plant.
3. ..... is a state that has factories that make medicines.
4. ..... is used to make varnish.
5. The Mahanadi meets the river ..... near Bilaspur.

E. Answer the following questions.

1. What is Bhimbetka known for?
2. Why is Madhya Pradesh sometimes called the heart of India?

3. Why are many factories located in Jharkhand?
4. What are the main occupations of the tribal people in these states?
5. What are some of the things that are made from the trees in the forests of Chhattisgarh?
6. Write two sentences each about two old monuments in Telangana.
7. In what two ways are these four states of central India similar?

THINGS TO DO

A. Picture study

Charminar, Hyderabad

Marble rocks near Jabalpur in Madhya Pradesh

Steel Plant in Bokaro, Jharkhand

Find out interesting details about these.

B. On your own

1. Collect stones (not brick or concrete) of different types from different places. Break the stones and study what they look like inside. Make up a story about your stones—where they came from and what happened to them.
2. Find out more about the colours of stones found in the old carvings in Chhattisgarh.

C. In a group

Make four groups and put together information about the states. Add more interesting details that you can find. Present your state to the rest of the class, inviting them to come and visit it.

WEBLINK

Tribal dance: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wfBiF7eDAv0 (accessed on 27 July 2017)